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Display device

Abstract

A display device includes a foldable display panel, a reinforcing member disposed in one surface of the display panel and that supports an entire surface of the display panel, and a cushion layer disposed in one surface of the reinforcing member. The reinforcing member includes a first reinforcing member layer and a second reinforcing member layer that is inserted into the first reinforcing member layer or at least partially surrounds the first reinforcing member layer, and one of the first reinforcing member layer or the second reinforcing member layer has an open area that is at least partially open.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION

(1) This application claims priority under 35 U.S.C. § 119 from Korean Patent Application No. 10-2022-0016968, filed on Feb. 9, 2022 in the Korean Intellectual Property Office, the contents of which are herein incorporated by reference in their entirety.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(2) One or more embodiments are directed to a device, and more particularly, to a display device.

DISCUSSION OF THE RELATED ART

(3) Mobile electronic devices, such as portable electronic devices, tablet PCs, as well as small-sized electronic devices, such as mobile phones, are becoming more widely used.

(4) A portable electronic device typically includes a display device that can support various functions and provide a user with visual information, such as images or videos. As the size of components for driving a display device has been reduced, the relevance of the display device in an electronic device has gradually increased, and a structure that can be bent from a flat state to a predetermined angle has been developed.

(5) Display devices can be used with an expanded screen by being folded or unfolded in various ways. When a display device is used in an unfolded state, a folded area may be or may not be visible to a user according to flatness of a display panel. When a folded area of the display panel is visible to the user, a distorted image may be provided to the user.

SUMMARY

(6) One or more embodiments of the present disclosure provide a display device that can implement a flat surface while being unfolded.

(7) According to an embodiment of the disclosure, a display device includes a foldable display panel, a reinforcing member disposed on one surface of the display panel and that supports an entire surface of the display panel, and a cushion layer disposed in one surface of the reinforcing member. The reinforcing member includes a first reinforcing member layer, and a second reinforcing member layer that is inserted into the first reinforcing member layer or at least partially surrounds the first reinforcing member layer. One of the first reinforcing member layer or the second reinforcing member layer has an open area that is at least partially open.

(8) One of the first reinforcing member layer or the second reinforcing member layer may include at least one of metal, glass reinforced fiber, or carbon reinforced fiber.

(9) An other of the first reinforcing member layer or the second reinforcing member layer may include at least one of a silicon-based polymer, a urethane-based polymer, an aramid-based polymer, or elastomer.

(10) The open area may include a plurality of open areas, and the plurality of open areas may be spaced apart from each other at constant intervals.

(11) The open area may have at least one of a non-defined shape, a polygonal shape, a circular shape, or an elliptical shape.

(12) The reinforcing member may further include an auxiliary layer disposed in the opening area.

(13) The auxiliary layer may be connected to one of the first reinforcing member layer or the second reinforcing member layer.

(14) A cross-sectional area of the auxiliary layer perpendicular to a lengthwise direction of the auxiliary layer may be less than a cross-sectional area of at least one of the first reinforcing member layer or the second reinforcing member layer perpendicular to a lengthwise direction of at least one of the first reinforcing member layer or the second reinforcing member layer.

- (15) The display device further includes a digitizer disposed on a lower surface of the reinforcing member or between the reinforcing member and the display panel.
 - (16) A thickness of the reinforcing member may be from about 50 μm to about 200 μm .
 - (17) According to an embodiment, a display device includes a cover member, a display panel disposed on a lower portion of the cover member; a reinforcing member disposed on a lower portion of the display panel; and a digitizer disposed on a lower portion of the reinforcing member. The reinforcing member includes a first reinforcing member layer that has a lattice shape, and a second reinforcing member layer disposed on a surface of the first reinforcing member layer or that surrounds the first reinforcing member layer.
 - (18) The lattice shape may include a plurality of open areas, and the open areas may have at least one of a circular shape, a polygonal shape, an elliptical shape, or a non-defined shape.
 - (19) At least a part of the second reinforcing member layer has the lattice shape.
 - (20) One of the first reinforcing member layer or the second reinforcing member layer may include at least one of metal, glass reinforced fiber, or carbon reinforced fiber, and an other of the first reinforcing member layer or the second reinforcing member layer may include at least one of a silicon-based polymer, an urethane-based polymer, an aramid-based polymer, or elastomer.
 - (21) An elastic coefficient of one of the first reinforcing member layer or the second reinforcing member layer may be from about 10 GPa to about 70 GPa.
 - (22) An elastic coefficient of an other one of the first reinforcing member layer or the second reinforcing member layer may be from about 0.1 GPa to about 10 GPa.
 - (23) The reinforcing member may further include an auxiliary layer connected to the first reinforcing member layer and disposed in the open areas.
 - (24) A cross-sectional area of the auxiliary layer may be less than a cross-sectional area of the first reinforcing member layer.
 - (25) A thickness of the first reinforcing member layer may be from about 10 μm to about 100 μm .
 - (26) A thickness of the reinforcing member may be from about 50 μm to about 200 μm .
 - (27) According to an embodiment, a display device includes a foldable display panel and a reinforcing member disposed on one surface of the display panel and that supports an entire surface of the display panel. The reinforcing member includes a first reinforcing member layer that has a lattice shape that includes an open area, and a second reinforcing member layer that is inserted into the first reinforcing member layer or at least partially surrounds the first reinforcing member layer.
 - (28) Such general and specific embodiments of the disclosure may be performed using systems, methods, computer-readable storage mediums, and/or combinations thereof.
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Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1A is a perspective view of a display device according to an embodiment of the disclosure.
- (2) FIG. 1B is a perspective view of a display device in a folded state according to an embodiment of the disclosure.
- (3) FIG. 1C is a cross-sectional view of a display device of FIG. 1A taken along line A-A'.
- (4) FIG. 1D is a cross-sectional view of a display device of FIG. 1A taken along line A-A'.
- (5) FIG. 2A is a perspective view of a display device according to an embodiment of the disclosure.
- (6) FIG. 2B is a cross-sectional view of a display device of FIG. 2A taken along line B-B'.
- (7) FIG. 3 is a plan view of a display panel of a display device of FIG. 1A or FIG. 2A.
- (8) FIGS. 4A and 4B are cross-sectional views of a display panel of FIG. 3 taken along line C-C'.
- (9) FIG. 5 is an equivalent circuit diagram of a pixel of a display panel of FIG. 3.
- (10) FIG. 6A is a perspective view of a reinforcing member of a display device of FIG. 1A or FIG. 2A.

- (11) FIG. 6B is a cross-sectional view of a reinforcing member of FIG. 6A taken along line D-D'.
- (12) FIGS. 7A to 7E are cross-sectional views of a reinforcing member of a display device according to one or more embodiments of the disclosure.
- (13) FIG. 8 is a plan view of a first reinforcing member layer or a second reinforcing member layer of a reinforcing member according to an embodiment of the disclosure.
- (14) FIG. 9 is a plan view of one of a first reinforcing member layer or a second reinforcing member layer of a reinforcing member according to an embodiment of the disclosure.
- (15) FIG. 10 is a plan view of one of a first reinforcing member layer or a second reinforcing member layer of a reinforcing member according to an embodiment of the disclosure.
- (16) FIG. 11 is a plan view of one of a first reinforcing member layer or a second reinforcing member layer of a reinforcing member according to an embodiment of the disclosure.
- (17) FIGS. 12A and 12B are plan views of one of a first reinforcing member layer or a second reinforcing member layer of a reinforcing member according to an embodiment of the disclosure.
- (18) FIG. 13 is a plan view of one of a first reinforcing member layer or a second reinforcing member layer of a reinforcing member according to an embodiment of the disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (19) Reference will now be made in detail to embodiments, examples of which are illustrated in the accompanying drawings, wherein like reference numerals may refer to like elements throughout.
- (20) The term “about” as used herein is inclusive of the stated value and means within an acceptable range of deviation for the particular value as determined by one of ordinary skill in the art, considering the measurement in question and the error associated with measurement of the particular quantity, such as the limitations of the measurement system. For example, “about” may mean within one or more standard deviations as understood by one of the ordinary skill in the art. Further, it is to be understood that while parameters may be described herein as having “about” a certain value, according to embodiments, the parameter may be exactly the certain value or approximately the certain value within a measurement error as would be understood by a person having ordinary skill in the art.
- (21) The embodiments will be described below in more detail with reference to the accompanying drawings. Those components that are the same or are in correspondence are rendered the same reference numeral regardless of the figure number, and redundant explanations are omitted.
- (22) It will be understood that when a layer, region, or component is referred to as being “formed on” another layer, region, or component, it may be directly or indirectly formed on the other layer, region, or component.
- (23) The x-axis, the y-axis and the z-axis are not limited to three axes of the rectangular coordinate system, and may be interpreted in a broader sense.
- (24) FIG. 1A is a perspective view of a display device 1 according to an embodiment of the disclosure. In detail, FIG. 1A is a perspective view of the display device 1 in an unfolded state, and FIG. 1B is a perspective view of the display device 1 in a folded state.
- (25) Referring to FIGS. 1A and 1B, in an embodiment, the display device 1 displays video or still images and can be used as a portable electronic device, such as a mobile phone, a smartphone, a tablet personal computer (PC), a mobile communication terminal, an electronic notebook, an electronic book, a portable multimedia player (PMP), a navigation terminal, an ultra-mobile PC (UMPC), etc., and also as a display screen in various products, such as a television, a laptop computer, a monitor, a billboard, internet of things (IoT), etc. In addition, the display device 1 can be used in a wearable device, such as a smart watch, a watch phone, a glasses-type display, and a head mounted display (HMD). In addition, the display device 1 can be used in a dashboard of a vehicle, a center information display in a center fascia or dashboard of a vehicle, a rear-view mirror display that replaces a side-view mirror of a vehicle, and a display in a rear side of a front seat as entertainment for the back seat in a vehicle.
- (26) The display device 1 includes a display panel 50 and a lower cover 90. The display panel 50

includes a display area DA that displays images, and a peripheral area PA around the display area DA. Pixels P that each include a display element are arranged in the display area DA. A plurality of pixels P are provided and are spaced apart from each other. The pixels P may emit light of different colors. The display device **1** provides images by emitting light from pixels P in the display area DA. The peripheral area PA is a non-display area in which the pixels P are not arranged.

(27) The display area DA includes a first display area DA**1**, a second display area DA**2**, and a third display area DA**3**. The pixels P may be arranged in each of the first display area DA**1**, the second display area DA**2**, and the third display area DA**3**. The display device **1** provides images via the pixels P arranged in the first display area DA**1**, the second display area DA**2**, and the third display area DA**3**. The first display area DA**1**, the second display area DA**2**, and the third display area DA**3** are surrounded by the peripheral area PA.

(28) The display panel **50** displays (outputs) information processed by the display device **1**. For example, the display panel **50** displays information about an execution screen of an application being executed by the display device **1**, or displays information in a user interface (UI) or a graphical user interface (GUI) according to the execution screen information. The display panel **50** includes a display layer that displays the image and a touchscreen layer that senses a touch input from a user. As such, the display panel **50** functions as one of the input devices that provide an input interface between the display device **1** and the user, and at the same time, functions as one of the output units that provide an output interface between the display device **1** and the user.

(29) Hereinafter, according to an embodiment, the display device **1** will be described as being an organic light-emitting display device, however, embodiments of the disclosure are not necessarily limited thereto. In an embodiment, the display apparatus **1** may include an inorganic light-emitting display or an inorganic EL display apparatus, or a quantum dot light-emitting display apparatus. For example, in embodiments, a light-emitting layer of a display element in the display apparatus **1** may include an organic material, an inorganic material, quantum dots, an organic material and quantum dots, or an inorganic material and quantum dots.

(30) In an embodiment, the display panel **50** is a flexible display panel that can be easily curved, folded, or rolled. For example, the display panel **50** includes one of a foldable display panel, a curved display panel that has curved display surface, a bendable display panel that has a bendable region other than the display surface, a rollable display panel that is rollable and spreadable, or a stretchable display panel. In an embodiment, the display panel **50** includes a rigid display panel that is rigid and not easily bendable.

(31) In an embodiment, the display panel **50** includes a first folding axis FAX**1** and a second folding axis FAX**2**. The display panel **50** can be folded about the first folding axis FAX**1** and the second folding axis FAX**2**. For example, a first foldable area FA**1** between the first display area DA**1** and the second display area DA**2** can be folded about the first folding axis FAX**1**, and a second foldable area FA**2** between the second display area DA**2** and the third display area DA**3** can be folded about the second folding axis FAX**2**.

(32) The first display area DA**1** and the second display area DA**2** are defined with the first folding axis FAX**1** therebetween. In addition, the second display area DA**2** and the third display area DA**3** are defined with the second folding axis FAX**2** therebetween.

(33) The lower cover **90** configures a lower outer appearance of the display device **1**. The lower cover **90** may include plastic, metal, or both plastic and metal. The lower cover **90** includes a first lower cover part **91** that supports the display panel **50**, a second lower cover part **92**, and a third lower cover part **93**. The lower cover **90** can be folded about the first folding axis FAX**1** between the first lower cover part **91** and the second lower cover part **92**. In addition, the lower cover **90** can be folded about the second folding axis FAX**2** between the second lower cover part **92** and the third lower cover part **93**.

(34) In an embodiment, a first hinge portion **90A** is provided between the first lower cover part **91** and the second lower cover part **92**, and a second hinge portion **90B** is provided between the

second lower cover part **92** and the third lower cover part **93**.

(35) In an embodiment, the first display area **DA1** and the second display area **DA2** can be folded to face each other based on the first folding axis **FAX1**. For example, the first lower cover part **91** and the second lower cover part **92** can be folded to not face each other based on the first folding axis **FAX1**. In an embodiment, the first display area **DA1** and the second display area **DA2** can be folded face each other based on the first folding axis **FAX1**.

(36) In an embodiment, the second display area **DA2** and the third display area **DA3** can be folded to not face each other based on the second folding axis **FAX2**. For example, the second lower cover part **92** and the third lower cover part **93** can be folded to not face each other based on the second folding axis **FAX2**. In an embodiment, the second display area **DA2** and the third display area **DA3** can be folded to face each other based on the second folding axis **FAX2**.

(37) In an embodiment, when the first display area **DA1** and the second display area **DA2** are folded to face each other, for example, are in-folding, a curvature of a folded portion is 5R or less. In embodiments, when the first display area **DA1** and the second display area **DA2** are in-folded to face each other, a curvature of a folded portion may be 3R, 1R, or less.

(38) In an embodiment, when the second display area **DA2** and the third display area **DA3** are folded to not face each other, for example, are out-folded, a curvature of the folded portion is 5R or less. In embodiments, when the second display area **DA2** and the third display area **DA3** are out-folded to not face each other, a curvature of the folded portion is 4R or less.

(39) FIG. **1C** is a cross-sectional view of a display device of FIG. **1A** taken along line A-A'.

(40) Referring to FIG. **1C**, in an embodiment, a cover member **10** is disposed on the display panel **50**. In an embodiment, the cover member **10** covers an upper portion of the display panel **50**. The cover member **10** protects the upper surface of the display panel **50**.

(41) In addition, in an embodiment, the cover member **10** includes a light-transmitting cover portion and a light-shielding cover portion, where the light-transmitting cover portion corresponds to the display panel **50** and the light-shielding cover portion corresponds to an area other than the display panel **50**. The light-shielding cover portion includes an opaque material that shields light. The light-shielding cover portion includes a pattern that is visible to a user when an image is not displayed.

(42) In an embodiment, the cover member **10** includes a cover window **11** and a protective member **12**. In an embodiment, the cover window **11** includes a transparent material. For example, the cover window **11** may include glass, a synthetic resin that includes a transparent material, etc. The cover window **11** includes at least one layer.

(43) In an embodiment, the protective member **12** is disposed on an upper surface of the cover window **11** to prevent or reduce scratches on the cover window **11**. An opaque layer **12a** is formed in part of the protective member **12**. In an embodiment, the opaque layer **12a** is arranged at an edge of the protective member **12**. The opaque layer **12a** blocks light.

(44) The display panel **50** is disposed under the cover member **10**. The display panel **50** is connected to a display circuit board **51** by a first flexible film **54**. A touch sensor driver **53** (see FIG. **3**) is disposed on the display circuit board **51**, and a display driver **52** is disposed on the first flexible film **54**. In an embodiment, the display driver **52** is disposed directly on a substrate **100** of the display panel **50**. For example, the display panel **50** and the display circuit board **51** are connected to each other by the first flexible film **54**, or the display panel **50** is directly connected to the display circuit board **51**. The substrate **100** of the display panel **50** is at least partially bent. A bending protective layer **BPL** is disposed on the bent portion of the substrate **100** to prevent cracks from generating in the substrate **100**. The bending protective layer **BPL** includes a polymer resin, such as a polyethylene terephthalate (PET) or a polyimide (PI) mesh, etc.

(45) The bending protective layer **BPL** shields a bendable region of the display panel **50**. One end of the bending protective layer **BPL** is in contact with an end of a functional layer **42** in a cross-section.

- (46) In an embodiment, the functional layer **42** is disposed on the display panel **50**, and a panel protective member **41** is disposed under the display panel **50**. The functional layer **42** is interposed between the cover window **11** and the display panel **50**. In addition, a touchscreen layer through which a touch signal input is received from a user is provided on the display panel **50**.
- (47) In an embodiment, the functional layer **42** is disposed on the touchscreen layer. The functional layer **42** includes an anti-reflection layer. The anti-reflection layer reduces reflectivity of external light incident through the display device **1**.
- (48) In some embodiments, the anti-reflection layer includes a polarization film. The polarization film includes a linear polarization plate and a phase retardation film, such as a $\lambda/4$ (quarter-wave) plate. The phase retardation film is disposed on the touchscreen layer, and the linear polarization plate is disposed on the phase retardation film.
- (49) In an embodiment, the anti-reflection layer includes a filter layer that includes a black matrix and color filters. The color filters are arranged based on a color of light emitted from each of sub-pixels in the display device **1**. For example, the filter layer includes a red, green, and blue color filter. For example, the display panel **50** includes a filter layer. The filter layer is disposed on a touchscreen layer of the display panel **50** without using an additional adhesive layer.
- (50) In an embodiment, the anti-reflection layer includes a destructive interference structure. The destructive interference structure includes a first reflective layer and a second reflective layer arranged on different layers. First reflected light and second reflected light that are respectively reflected by the first reflective layer and the second reflective layer destructively interfere with each other, and accordingly, a reflectivity of external light is reduced.
- (51) In an embodiment, the functional layer **42** further includes a shock absorbing layer. The shock absorbing layer protects structures, such as the display panel thereunder, against external shock. In an embodiment, the shock absorbing layer includes a polymer film. The polymer film includes, for example, at least one of polyethylene terephthalate (PET), polyethylene naphthalate (PEN), polyether sulfone (PES), polyimide (PI), polyarylate (PAR), polycarbonate (PC), polymethyl methacrylate (PMMA), or cyclo olefin copolymer (COC).
- (52) In an embodiment, the functional layer **42** includes an anti-reflection layer and a shock absorbing layer. The anti-reflection layer and the shock absorbing layer are sequentially stacked on the display panel **50**.
- (53) The functional layer **42** determines the positions of the ends of the bending protective layer BPL. For example, the bending protective layer BPL is formed of a resin that is supplied onto the substrate **100** of the display panel **50**. Because the bending protective layer BPL is flowable, the bending protective layer BPL can flow in various directions on the display panel **50** without staying at a certain position on the display panel **50**. However, when the functional layer **42** is disposed on the display panel **50**, ends of the functional layer **42** prevent the bending protective layer BPL from flowing into the region of the display panel **50** in which the functional layer **42** is disposed, and limit the region on which the bending protective layer BPL flows. Therefore, the bending protective layer BPL is arranged only in the peripheral area of the display panel **50** and may in the display area DA.
- (54) A fifth adhesive layer **88** is located between the functional layer **42** and the display panel **50**. The fifth adhesive member **88** adheres the functional layer **42** to the display panel **50**. The fifth adhesive layer **88** may be a pressure sensitive adhesive (PSA) or a transparent adhesive layer, such as an optically clear adhesive (OCA).
- (55) The cover member **10** is disposed on the functional layer **42**. The cover member **10** is adhered onto the functional layer **42** by a first adhesive member **81**. In an embodiment, the first adhesive member **81** is a PSA or a transparent adhesive layer, such as an OCA.
- (56) In an embodiment, a protective film PFI is disposed under the display panel **50**. The protective film PFI absorbs impacts received from the outside of the display device **1**. For example, the protective film PFI includes an open area PFI-OP that corresponds to a bendable area of the display

panel **50**, as described below. A width of the open area PFI-OP is less than that of the bendable area of the display panel **50**.

(57) The panel protective member **41** is disposed under the protective film PFI. The panel protective member **41** is adhered to the lower portion of the protective film PFI via a PSA. However, embodiments are not necessarily limited thereto.

(58) In an embodiment, a digitizer **70** is disposed under the display panel **50**. The digitizer **70** includes a pattern layer that senses a signal received from an external electronic pen, etc. In particular, the digitizer **70** can sense an intensity, a direction, etc., of the signal received from the electronic pen, etc. The digitizer **70** is electrically connected to a main circuit board that is separately provided. However, embodiments are not necessarily limited thereto.

(59) The digitizer **70** according to an embodiment include a first portion **70a**, a second portion **70b**, and a third portion **70c**. In an embodiment, the first portion **70a** of the digitizer **70** at least partially overlaps the first display area DA1, the second portion **70b** of the digitizer **70** least partially overlaps the second display area DA2, and the third portion **70c** of the digitizer **70** least partially overlaps the third display area DA3. In addition, the first portion **70a** and the second portion **70b** of the digitizer **70** at least partially overlap the first foldable area FA1, and the second portion **70b** and the third portion **70c** of the digitizer **70** at least partially overlap the second foldable area FA2.

(60) In an embodiment, the first portion **70a** and the second portion **70b** of the digitizer **70** are spaced apart from each other in a first direction (x-direction) with the first folding axis FAX1 therebetween. In addition, the second portion **70b** and the third portion **70c** of the digitizer **70** are spaced apart from each other in the first direction (x-direction) with the second folding axis FAX2 therebetween. For example, the digitizer **70** has separate components, and is not an integrated component. Because the digitizer **70** has separate components, the generation of cracks in the digitizer **70** in the first folding area FA1 and the second folding area FA2 is prevented or reduced.

(61) In an above example, the digitizer **70** is provided with separate components that at least partially overlap the first foldable area FA1 and the second foldable area FA2, and thus, the first foldable area FA1 and the second foldable area FA2 also receive a signal input, which can increase user convenience.

(62) In an embodiment, a reinforcing member **60** is interposed between the display panel **50** and the digitizer **70**. In an embodiment, the reinforcing member **60** is disposed under the display panel **50** and supports the display panel **50**.

(63) The reinforcing member **60** may have various structures, depending on whether the display device **1** is a folded or a folding type. For example, when the display device **1** is not folded, the reinforcing member **60** has a invariant shape.

(64) The reinforcing member **60** includes a first reinforcing member layer **60-2** and a second reinforcing member layer **60-1**. In embodiments, the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** and the second reinforcing member layer **60-1** are stacked with each other, or one of the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** and the second reinforcing member layer **60-1** are arranged inside the other.

(65) The reinforcing member **60** includes a reinforcing member foldable area **60a**, in which the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** is combined with the second reinforcing member layer **60-1**. The reinforcing member foldable area **60a** is arranged in at least a part of the reinforcing member **60**.

(66) In an embodiment, the reinforcing member foldable area **60a** is arranged in a part of the reinforcing member **60** that is located in a portion of the display device **1** that is folded when the display device **1** is folded. In an embodiment, the reinforcing member foldable area **60a** is disposed on the entire surface of the display device **1**. Hereinafter, for convenience of description, an embodiment in which the reinforcing member foldable area **60a** is arranged only in a portion of the reinforcing member **60** in which the display device **1** is bent will be described in detail.

(67) In an embodiment, when folding the display device **1**, the reinforcing member foldable area **60a** is folded about the first folding axis FAX1 and the second folding axis FAX2. In an embodiment, opposite sides of the reinforcing member foldable area **60a** are symmetrical with each

other about the first folding axis FAX1 and the second folding axis FAX2. In an embodiment, the reinforcing member **60** has a flat upper surface.

(68) In an embodiment, the reinforcing member **60** includes at least one of glass, plastic, or metal. In an embodiment, the reinforcing member **60** includes one of glass and plastic, glass and metal, plastic and metal, or glass, plastic, and metal.

(69) Referring back to FIG. **1C**, in an embodiment, the reinforcing member **60** is adhered to the panel protective member **41** by a second adhesive member **83**. In an embodiment, the second adhesive member **83** is a PSA or a transparent adhesive member, such as an OCA film.

(70) In an embodiment, the reinforcing member **60** and the digitizer **70** are adhered by a third adhesive member **85**. In an embodiment, the third adhesive member **85** may include a PSA, an OCA film, or a thermoplastic polyurethane (TPU).

(71) In an embodiment, the third adhesive member **85** is located under the reinforcing member **60**.

(72) In an embodiment, a cushion layer **80** is disposed under the digitizer **70**. The cushion layer **80** includes a sticky material. In an embodiment, the cushion layer **80** prevents or reduces damage to the digitizer **70** disposed thereon due to external shock.

(73) In an embodiment, an insulating film **89** is disposed under the cushion layer **80**. Because the cushion layer **80** includes a sticky material, the cushion layer **80** can attach to another member and interfere with the folding of the display device **1**. Therefore, because the insulating film **89** is attached to the lower portion of the cushion layer **80**, the cushion layer **80** can be prevented from attaching to another member, so that the display device **1** can be easily folded.

(74) In an embodiment, a fourth adhesive member **87** is disposed under the digitizer **70**. In an embodiment, the fourth adhesive member **87** includes a PSA or an OCA film. However, embodiments are not necessarily limited thereto. In addition, in an embodiment, the digitizer **70** is connected to a main circuit board that is separately provided, by the fourth adhesive member **87**. However, embodiments are not necessarily limited thereto.

(75) The main circuit board may be provided separately from or integrally with the display circuit board **51**. When the main circuit board and the display circuit board **51** are separately provided, the main circuit board and the display circuit board **51** may be connected to each other by a cable, etc. However, for convenience of description, an embodiment in which the main circuit board is separately provided from the display circuit board **51** is described in detail below.

(76) The main circuit board includes a main processor, a camera device, a main connector, and components. The main processor includes an integrated circuit. The camera device is disposed on both an upper surface and a lower surface of the main circuit board, and each of the main processor and the main connector are disposed on one of the upper or lower surfaces of the main circuit board.

(77) The main processor controls all functions of the display device **1**. For example, the main processor outputs digital video data to the display driver **52** through the display circuit board **51**, such that the display panel **50** can display an image. In addition, the main processor receives sensing data from the touch sensor driver **53**. The main processor determines whether there is a user's touch according to the sensing data, and performs an operation corresponding to a direct touch or a proximate touch by the user. For example, the main processor calculates a touch coordinate of the user by analyzing the sensing data, and executes an application or performs an operation indicated by an icon touched by the user. The main processor may be one of an application processor, a central processing unit, or a system chip that includes an integrated circuit.

(78) The camera device processes image frames of a still image or a moving picture obtained by an image sensor in a camera mode, and outputs the processed result to the main processor. The camera device includes at least one of a camera sensor, such as a CCD, a CMOS, etc., a photo or image sensor, or a laser sensor. The camera device is connected to the image sensor and processes the image input to the image sensor.

(79) A cable passes through a cable hole of a bracket and is connected to the main connector, and

thus, the main circuit board is electrically connected to the display circuit board **51**.

(80) The main circuit board further includes, in addition to the main processor, the camera device, and the main connector, at least one wireless communication unit, at least one input unit, at least one sensor unit, at least one output unit, at least one interface unit, a memory, and a power supplier.

(81) The wireless communication unit includes at least one of a broadcast receiving module, a mobile communication module, a near field communication module, or a position information module.

(82) The broadcast receiving module receives a broadcast signal and/or broadcast-related information from an external broadcast management server through a broadcast channel. The broadcast channel includes satellite channels and terrestrial channels.

(83) The mobile communication module transmits/receives a wireless signal to/from at least one of a base station, an external terminal, or a server on a mobile communication network established according to technology standards or communication methods for mobile communication, such as global system for mobile communication (GSM), code division multi access (CDMA), CDMA2000, enhanced voice-data optimized or enhanced voice-data only (EV-DO), wideband CDMA (WCDMA), high speed downlink packet access (HSDPA), high speed uplink packet access (HSUPA), long term evolution (LTE), long term evolution-advanced (LTE-A), etc. The wireless signal may be a voice call signal, a video call signal, or various types of data according to transmission/reception of texts/multimedia messages.

(84) A wireless Internet module is a module that accesses wireless Internet. The wireless Internet module can transmit/receive a wireless signal in a communication network according to wireless Internet technologies. The wireless Internet technology may be, for example, wireless LAN (WLAN), wireless-fidelity (Wi-Fi), Wi-Fi direct, digital living network alliance (DLNA), etc.

(85) A short-range communication module supports short-range communication by using at least one of Bluetooth™, Radio Frequency Identification (RFID), Infrared Data Association (IrDA), Ultra Wideband (UWB), ZigBee, Near Field Communication (NFC), Wi-Fi, Wi-Fi Direct, or Wireless Universal Serial Bus (USB). The short-range communication module supports wireless communication between the display device **1** and a wireless communication system, between the display device **1** and another electronic device, or between the display device **1** and a network in which another electronic device or an external server is located through wireless area networks. The wireless area network may include a wireless personal area network. Another electronic device may include a wearable device that can exchange data with the display device **1**.

(86) The position information module obtains a location of the display device **1**, and examples of the position information module include a global positioning system (GPS) module or a Wi-Fi module. For example, when using a GPS module, the display device **1** obtains the location of the display device **1** by using a signal provided from a GPS satellite. In addition, when using a Wi-Fi module, the display device **1** can obtain the location of the display device **1**, based on information of a wireless access point (AP) that transmits or receives a wireless signal to/from the Wi-Fi module. The position information module obtains the location of the display device **1** and not necessarily limited to a module that directly calculates or obtains the location of the display device **1**.

(87) The input unit includes an image input unit, such as the camera device, that receives image signals, a sound input unit, such as a microphone, that receives sound signals, and an input device that receives information from a user.

(88) The camera device process image frames, such as still images, moving pictures, etc., obtained by the image sensor in a video call mode or a photographing mode. The processed image frame can be displayed on the display panel **50** or stored in the memory.

(89) The microphone processes a sound signal received from outside as electrical voice data. The voice data can be variously used according to the function performed by the display device **1**, or the application being executed. The microphone uses various noise canceling algorithms that cancel

noise generated when receiving the sound signal from the outside.

(90) The main processor controls operations of the display device **1** so as to correspond to information received from the input device. The input device may include a mechanical input unit, such as a button located on a rear surface or a side surface of the display device **1**, a dome switch, a jog-wheel, a jog switch, etc., or a touch input unit. The touch input unit includes a touchscreen layer of the display panel **50**.

(91) The sensor unit includes one or more sensors that sense at least one of information in the display device **1**, peripheral environment information of the display device **1**, or user information, and generate a sensing signal corresponding to the sensed information. The main processor controls driving or operation of the display device **1**, processes data, or perform functions or operations regarding an application installed on the display device **1**, based on the sensing signal. The sensor unit includes at least one of a proximity sensor, an illumination sensor, an acceleration sensor, a magnetic sensor, a G-sensor, a gyroscope sensor, a motion sensor, an RGB sensor, an infrared ray (IR) sensor, a finger scan sensor, an ultrasonic sensor, an optical sensor, a battery gauge, an environmental sensor, such as a barometer, a hydrometer, a thermometer, a radiation detection sensor, a heat detection sensor, a gas detection sensor, etc., or a chemical sensor, such as an electronic nose, a healthcare sensor, a biometric sensor, etc.

(92) The proximity sensor senses a presence of an object that is approaching a predetermined detection surface or an object around the detection surface by using an electromagnetic field or a infrared light, without a physical contact. Examples of a proximity sensor include a transmission-type photoelectric sensor, a direct reflective photoelectric sensor, a mirror reflective photoelectric sensor, a radio frequency oscillation-type proximity sensor, a capacitive-type proximity sensor, a magnetic-type proximity sensor, an infrared proximity sensor, etc. The proximity sensor senses a proximity touch pattern, such as a proximity touch distance, a proximity touch direction, a proximity touch speed, a proximity touch time, a proximity touch position, and/or a proximity touch movement, etc., as well as the proximity touch. The main processor processes data or information that corresponds to the proximate touch operation or the proximate touch pattern sensed by the proximity sensor, and controls visual information that corresponds to processed data to be displayed on the display panel **50**.

(93) The ultrasonic sensor recognizes position information of an object. The main processor calculates a position of an object through information sensed by the optical sensor and a plurality of ultrasonic sensors. Because the speed of light and the speed of ultrasonic waves differ from each other, the position of an object is calculated by using a time taken for the light to reach the optical sensor and a time for the ultrasonic wave to reach the ultrasound sensor.

(94) The output unit generates an output related to a visual, auditory, or tactile sense, and includes at least one of the display panel **50**, a sound output unit, a haptic module, or an optical output unit.

(95) The sound output unit outputs sound data received from the wireless communication unit or stored in the memory in a call signal reception, a call mode or a recording mode, a voice recognition mode, a broadcast reception mode, etc. The sound output unit outputs a sound signal related to the function executed on the display device **1**, such as a call signal reception sound, a message reception sound, etc. The sound output unit includes a receiver and a speaker. At least one of the receiver or the speaker is a sound generation device that is attached to a lower portion of the display panel **50** to vibrate the display panel **50** and output sound. The sound generation device includes a piezoelectric element or a piezoelectric actuator that contracts and expands according to an electric signal, or an exciter that generates a magnetic force by using a voice coil to vibrate the display panel **50**.

(96) The haptic module generates various tactile effects that a user can feel. The haptic module provides the user with a vibration as the tactile effect. An intensity and pattern of the vibrations generated by the haptic module are controlled by a selection of the user or a setting of the main processor. For example, the haptic module synthesizes and outputs different vibrations or

sequentially outputs the different vibrations. The haptic module can generate various tactile effects, such as an arrangement of pins that move vertically to contact the skin surface, an air injection force or an air suction force through an injection port or a suction port, a grazing on the skin surface, a contact of an electrode, effects caused by stimulation of an electromagnetic force, or effects caused by producing a cooling and warming feeling by using endothermic or exothermic elements. The haptic module can be implemented such that the user can feel the tactile effect through muscle sensation, such as a finger, an arm, etc., as well as through direct contact.

(97) The optical output unit outputs a signal that notifies an occurrence of an event by using light from a light source. Examples of an event occurring on the display device **1** include a message reception, a call signal reception, a missed call, an alarm, a schedule notification, an email reception, an information reception through an application, etc. The signal output from the optical output unit occurs when the display device **1** emits light of a single color or a plurality of colors through a front surface or a rear surface thereof. The signal output terminates when the display device **1** senses that the user identifies the event.

(98) The interface unit is a path to various external devices connected to the display device **1**. The interface unit includes at least one of a wired/wireless headset port, an external charger port, a wired/wireless data port, a memory card port, a port that connects a device that includes an identification module, an audio input/output (I/O) port, a video I/O port, or an earphones port. The display device **1** performs an appropriate control regarding an external device connected thereto, in response to the connection of the external device to the interface unit.

(99) The memory stores data that supports various functions of the display device **1**. The memory stores a plurality of application programs executed by the display device **1**, data for operating the display device **1**, and instructions. At least some of the plurality of application programs are downloaded from an external server through wireless communication. The memory stores an application for operating the main processor and can temporarily store input/output data, such as data such as a phone book, messages, still images, videos, etc. In addition, the memory can store haptic data for various vibration patterns provided to the haptic module and sound data provided to the sound output unit. The memory includes at least one of a flash memory type, a hard disk type, a solid state disk (SSD) type, a silicon disk drive (SSD) type, a multimedia card micro type, a card type, such as SD or XD memory, etc., a random access memory (RAM), a static RAM (SRAM), a read-only memory (ROM), an electrically erasable programmable ROM (EEPROM), a programmable ROM (PROM), a magnetic memory, a magnetic disk, or an optical disk.

(100) The power supplier supplies electric power to each of elements in the display device **1** by receiving external and internal power under control of the main processor. The power supplier may include a battery. In addition, the power supplier includes a connection port, and the connection port may be an example of the interface unit to which an external charger that supplies the electric power that charges the battery is electrically connected. In an embodiment, the power supplier wirelessly charges the battery without using the connection port. The battery receives the electric power from an external wireless power transfer device by at least one of an inductive coupling method based on a magnetic induction phenomenon, or a magnetic resonance coupling method based on an electromagnetic resonance phenomenon. The battery does not overlap the main circuit board in a third direction (Z-direction). The battery overlaps a battery hole of the bracket.

(101) The lower cover **90** is disposed under the main circuit board and the battery. The lower cover **90** is coupled and fixed to the bracket. The lower cover **90** configures a lower outer appearance of the display device **1**. The lower cover **90** includes at least one of plastic, metal, or both plastic and metal.

(102) Therefore, the display device **1** prevents the end of the cover member **10** from becoming separated therefrom. In addition, because there is no space between the functional layer **42** and the bending protective layer BPL in the display device **1**, foreign matter that may be introduced through the space, static electricity, etc. can be prevented. In the display device **1**, the bending

protective layer BPL is accurately arranged so as to prevent damage to the substrate **100** when bending the substrate **100** of the display panel **50**.

(103) FIG. **1D** is a cross-sectional view of the display device **1** of FIG. **1A** taken along line A-A'.

(104) Referring to FIG. **1D**, in an embodiment, the display device **1** includes the cover member **10**, the panel protective member **41**, the functional layer **42**, the display panel **50**, the protective film PFI, the reinforcing member **60**, the digitizer **70**, the cushion layer **80**, the insulating film **89**, and the lower cover **90**. Here, the cover member **10**, the panel protective member **41**, the functional layer **42**, the display panel **50**, the protective film PFI, the reinforcing member **60**, the digitizer **70**, the cushion layer **80**, the insulating film **89**, and the lower cover **90** are the same as or similar to those described above with reference to FIGS. **1A** to **1C**.

(105) The digitizer **70** is disposed under the display panel **50** and above the reinforcing member **60**. The digitizer **70** includes the first portion **70a**, the second portion **70b**, and the third portion **70c** as described above with reference to FIG. **1C**.

(106) In addition, an additional barrier film is interposed between the display panel **50** and the reinforcing member **60** of FIG. **1C** or between the display panel **50** and the digitizer **70** of FIG. **1D**. The barrier film is disposed on the rear surface of the display panel **50** and prevents scratches, etc., that can occur while manufacturing the display panel **50**. The barrier film includes a colored polyimide film. For example, the barrier film includes an opaque yellow film, but is not necessarily limited thereto.

(107) FIG. **2A** is a perspective view of the display device **1** according to an embodiment of the disclosure. FIG. **2B** is a cross-sectional view of the display device **1** of FIG. **2A** taken along line B-B'.

(108) Referring to FIGS. **2A** and **2B**, in an embodiment, the display device **1** includes the display area DA, and the peripheral area PA around the display area DA. In an embodiment, the display device **1** includes a foldable area FA, and the display area DA includes a first display area DA1 and a second display area DA2 that are spaced apart from each other with the foldable area FA therebetween. The display area DA, the foldable area FA, and the peripheral area PA are similar to or the same as those described in FIG. **1A**, and detailed descriptions thereof are omitted.

(109) In an embodiment, the display device **1** includes the cover member **10**, the panel protective member **41**, the functional layer **42**, the display panel **50**, the protective film PFI, the reinforcing member **60**, the cushion layer **80**, the insulating film **89**, and the lower cover **90**. The cover member **10**, the panel protective member **41**, the display panel **50**, the protective film PFI, the reinforcing member **60**, the cushion layer **80**, the insulating film **89**, and the lower cover **90** are the same as or similar to those described above with reference to FIGS. **1A** to **1C**.

(110) The functional layer **42** is disposed on the touchscreen layer. The functional layer **42** includes an anti-reflection layer. The anti-reflection layer reduces a reflectivity of external light incident through the display device **1**.

(111) In some embodiments, the anti-reflection layer includes a polarization film. The polarization film includes a linear polarization plate and a phase retardation film, such as a $\lambda/4$ (quarter-wave) plate. The phase retardation film is disposed on the touchscreen layer, and the linear polarization plate is disposed on the phase retardation film.

(112) In an embodiment, the anti-reflection layer includes a destructive interference structure. The destructive interference structure includes a first reflective layer and a second reflective layer arranged on different layers. First reflected light and second reflected light that are respectively reflected by the first reflective layer and the second reflective layer destructively interfere with each other, which reduces reflectivity of external light.

(113) A first adhesive member **81** is arranged between the cover member **10** and the functional layer **42**, and a fifth adhesive member **88** is arranged between the functional layer **42** and the display panel **50**. A third adhesive member **85** is arranged between the reinforcing member **60** and the cushion layer **80**, and a fourth adhesive member **87** is disposed under the third adhesive

member **85**.

(114) Hereinafter, “upper portion” denotes a direction in which the cover member **10** is located based on the display panel **50**, that is, +z direction, and “lower portion” denotes a direction in which the cushion layer **80** is located based on the display panel **50**, that is, -z direction.

(115) In an embodiment, the display device **1** has a rectangular shape on a plane. For example, the display device **1** has a rectangular planar shape that has longer sides in the first direction (x-direction) and shorter sides in the second direction (y-direction) that crosses the first direction (x-direction), as shown in FIG. 2A. A corner where the longer side in the first direction (x-direction) and the shorter side in the second direction (y-direction) meet each other may be rounded with a predetermined curvature or may be right-angled. The planar shape of the display device **1** is not necessarily limited to a rectangular shape, and may have other planar shapes, such as a polygonal shape, an elliptical shape, or an undefined shape.

(116) In an embodiment, the display device **1** has various shapes. For example, the display device **1** has a shape that does not vary. In an embodiment, the display device **1** may be at least partially folded. The display device **1** may be an in-folding type in which the display area DA is folded to face each other when the display device **1** is folded, or an out-folding type in which the display area DA is exposed to outside when the display device **1** is folded. Hereinafter, for convenience of description, an example in which the display device **1** is an in-folding type will be described below.

(117) In an embodiment, the display device **1** is folded based about a folding axis FAX. In this case, when the display device **1** is folded based on (or about) the folding axis FAX, the size of the display device **1** may reduce as compared with that when the display device **1** is completely unfolded.

(118) Therefore, when the display device **1** is completely folded, a large display screen may be implemented, and when the display device **1** is completely folded, the size of the display device **1** is reduced and results in improving the portability of the display device **1**.

(119) FIG. 3 is a plan view of the display panel **50** of the display device **1** of FIG. 1A or FIG. 2A.

(120) Referring to FIG. 3, in an embodiment, the display panel **50** is disposed under the cover member **10**. In an embodiment, the display panel **50** of the display device **1** includes the display area DA and the peripheral area PA. Therefore, display elements are arranged in the display area DA of the display panel **50** to display images, and no display elements are arranged in the peripheral area PA of the display panel **50**, so that images are not displayed.

(121) The display panel **50** as above includes a first area **1A**, a bendable area BA, and a second area **2A**. The first area **1A** includes the display area DA and a part of the peripheral area PA adjacent to the display area DA, the bendable area BA includes a bending axis BAX that is arranged in the peripheral area PA, and the second area **2A** is connected to the bendable area BA and is in the peripheral area PA so that terminals can be arranged therein. The first area **1A** can be maintained flat or folded.

(122) In an embodiment, the display panel **50** includes display elements. The display elements include light-emitting display panels that include light emitting diodes. In an embodiment, the display panel **50** is one of an organic light-emitting display panel that uses an organic light-emitting diode that includes an organic light-emitting layer, a micro-LED display panel that uses a micro-LED, a quantum dot light-emitting display panel that uses a quantum dot light-emitting diode that includes a quantum dot light-emitting layer, or an inorganic light-emitting display panel that uses an inorganic light-emitting device that includes an inorganic semiconductor.

(123) In an embodiment, the display panel **50** may be a rigid display panel that is not easily bent, or a flexible display panel that is flexible and can be easily bent, folded, or rolled. For example, the display panel **50** is one of a foldable display panel, a curved display panel that has a curved display surface, a bendable display panel that has a bendable region other than the display surface, a rollable display panel that is rollable and spreadable, or a stretchable display panel.

(124) The display panel **50** is transparent so that an object or background under the display panel

50 can be seen from above the display panel **50**. In an embodiment, the display panel **50** includes a reflective display panel that reflects an object or background above the display panel **50**.

(125) In an embodiment, a first flexible film **54** is attached to one edge of the display panel **50**. A side of the first flexible film **54** is attached to one edge of the display panel **50** via an anisotropic conductive film. The first flexible film **54** can be bent.

(126) In an embodiment, the display driver **52** is disposed on the first flexible film **54**. The display driver **52** receives control signals and power voltages, and generates and outputs signals and voltages that drive the display panel **50**. The display driver **52** includes an integrated circuit (IC).

(127) In an embodiment, the display circuit board **51** is attached to the other side of the first flexible film **54**. The opposite side of the first flexible film **54** is attached to an upper surface of the display circuit board **51**. The display circuit board **51** is one of a flexible printed circuit board (FPCB) that is bendable, a rigid printed circuit board (PCB) that is hard and rarely bendable, or a composite printed circuit board that includes both the rigid PCB and the FPCB.

(128) In an embodiment, a touch sensor driver **53** is disposed on the display circuit board **51**. The touch sensor driver **53** may include an integrated circuit. The touch sensor driver **53** is attached onto the display circuit board **51**. The touch sensor driver **53** is electrically connected to touch electrodes in the touchscreen layer of the display panel **50** through the display circuit board **51**.

(129) The touchscreen layer of the display panel **50** can sense a user's touch input by using at least one of various touch methods, such as a resistive overlay method, a capacitive overlay method, etc. For example, when the touchscreen layer of the display panel **50** senses a user's touch input in a capacitive overlay method, the touch sensor driver **53** transmits driving signals to driving electrodes of the touch electrodes and senses voltages charged in mutual capacitance between the driving electrodes and sensing electrodes by using the sensing electrodes of the touch electrodes to determine whether a user's touch has occurred. The user's touch may include a touch and a proximity touch. The touch may be that of a user's finger or an object such as a pen that directly contacts the cover member **10** on the touchscreen layer. The proximity touch may be that a user's finger or an object such as a pen is close to the cover member **10**, but not in direct contact with the cover member **10**, e.g., hovering. The touch sensor driver **53** transmits sensor data to the main processor according to sensed voltages, and the main processor analyzes the sensor data and calculates a touch coordinate of the touch input.

(130) A power supply that supplies driving voltages that drive sub-pixels, a scan driver, and the display driver **52** of the display panel **50** is additionally disposed on the display circuit board **51**. In an embodiment, the power supplier is integrated with the display driver **52**, and the display driver **52** and the power supplier are provided as one integrated circuit.

(131) FIGS. **4A** and **4B** are cross-sectional views of the display panel **50** of FIG. **3** taken along line C-C'. FIGS. **4A** and **4B** show a first transistor **T1** and a third transistor **T3** of first to seventh transistors **T1** to **T7** of FIG. **5** that will be described below.

(132) Referring to FIG. **4A**, in an embodiment, the display panel **50** includes a substrate **BS**, a buffer layer **311**, insulating layers **IL**, a light-emitting device **OLED1**, a thin film encapsulation layer **340**, an input sensor **350**, a black matrix **360**, a color filter **370**, and an overcoat layer **380**.

(133) The substrate **BS** has a structure in which an organic layer and an inorganic layer are alternately stacked. For example, the substrate **BS** includes a first base layer **301**, a first barrier layer **302**, a second base layer **303**, and a second barrier layer **304** which are sequentially stacked.

(134) The first base layer **301** includes an organic material. For example, the first base layer **301** includes one of polyimide, polyethylene naphthalate, polyethylene terephthalate, polyarylate, polycarbonate, polyether imide, or polyether sulfone.

(135) The first barrier layer **302** is disposed on the first base layer **301**. The first barrier layer **302** includes an inorganic material. For example, the first barrier **302** includes at least one of silicon oxide, silicon oxynitride, silicon nitride, amorphous silicon, etc. In an embodiment, the first barrier layer **302** includes a first layer and a second layer, and the second layer has a refractive index that

is less than that of the first layer. For example, the first layer includes silicon oxynitride, and the second layer includes silicon oxide, which has a lesser refractive index than the silicon oxynitride. (136) The second base layer **303** is disposed on the first barrier layer **302**. The second base layer **303** includes the same material as the first base layer **301**. However, embodiments are not necessarily limited thereto. In an embodiment, the second base layer **303** includes a different material from the first base layer **301**. In an embodiment, a thickness of the second base layer **303** is less than that of the first base layer **301**.

(137) The second barrier layer **304** is disposed on the second base layer **303**. The second barrier layer **304** includes an inorganic material. For example, the second barrier layer **304** includes at least one of silicon oxide, silicon oxynitride, silicon nitride, etc. In an embodiment, the second barrier layer **304** includes a first layer and a second layer, and the second layer has a refractive index that is less than that of the first layer. For example, the first layer includes silicon oxynitride, and the second layer includes silicon oxide, which has a lesser refractive index than the silicon oxynitride.

(138) The buffer layer **311** is disposed on the substrate BS. The buffer layer **311** reduces or blocks infiltration of foreign substances, moisture, or external air from the lower portion of the substrate BS. The buffer layer **311** includes an inorganic material such as silicon oxide, silicon oxynitride, or silicon nitride, and may have a single-layered or a multi-layered structure that includes the above-stated materials.

(139) A semiconductor pattern is disposed on the buffer layer **311**. Hereinafter, the semiconductor pattern directly disposed on the buffer layer **311** is referred to as a first semiconductor pattern. The first semiconductor pattern includes a silicon semiconductor. In an embodiment, the first semiconductor pattern includes polysilicon. However, embodiments are not necessarily limited thereto. In an embodiment, the first semiconductor pattern includes amorphous silicon.

(140) FIG. 4A shows a part of the first semiconductor pattern, and another first semiconductor pattern is further arranged in another region of the pixel PX. The first semiconductor pattern includes a doping area and a non-doping area. The doping area is doped with an N-type dopant or a P-type dopant. A P-type transistor includes a P-type dopant doped in the doping area.

(141) A first transistor **T1** includes a source **S1**, an active region **A1**, and a drain **D1**. The source **S1**, the active region **A1**, and the drain **D1** of the first transistor **T1** are formed from the first semiconductor pattern. The source **S1** and the drain **D1** of the first transistor **T1** are spaced apart from each other with the active region **A1** of the first transistor **T1** therebetween.

(142) A connecting signal line SCL is further disposed on the buffer layer **311**. The connecting signal line SCL is connected to a drain **D6** of a sixth trace line **T6** (see FIG. 5) on a plane. However, in an embodiment, the connecting signal line SCL is omitted.

(143) A first insulating layer **313** of the insulating layers IL is disposed on the buffer layer **311**. The first insulating layer **313** covers the first semiconductor pattern. In an embodiment, the first insulating layer **313** includes an inorganic material such as silicon oxide, silicon oxynitride, or silicon nitride, and may have a single-layered or a multi-layered structure that includes the above stated materials.

(144) A gate **G1** of the first transistor **T1** is disposed on the first insulating layer **313**. The gate **G1** is a part of a metal pattern. The gate **G1** of the first transistor **T1** at least partially overlaps the first semiconductor pattern disposed thereunder. For example, the gate **G1** overlaps the active region **A1** disposed thereunder. The gate **G1** may have a single-layered or a multi-layered structure that includes a low-resistive conductive material such as molybdenum (Mo), aluminum (Al), copper (Cu), and/or titanium (Ti).

(145) A second insulating layer **314** of the insulating layers IL is disposed on the first insulating layer **313**. The second insulating layer **314** covers the gate **G1** of the first transistor **T1**. The second insulating layer **314** includes an inorganic material such as silicon oxide, silicon oxynitride, or silicon nitride, and may have a single-layered or a multi-layered structure including the above stated materials.

(146) An upper electrode UE is disposed on the second insulating layer **314**. The upper electrode UE at least partially overlaps the gate G1 of the first transistor T1 disposed thereunder. The upper electrode UE is a part of a metal pattern or a doped semiconductor pattern. A part of the gate G1 and the upper electrode UE that overlap the gate G1 form a first storage capacitor Cst (see FIG. 5). However, in an embodiment, the upper electrode UE is omitted.

(147) In addition, a first electrode CE1 (see FIG. 5) and a second electrode CE2 (see FIG. 5) of the first storage capacitor Cst (see FIG. 5) are manufactured respectively through the same processes as the gate G1 and the upper electrode UE. The first electrode CE1 is disposed on the first insulating layer **313**, and the first electrode CE1 is electrically connected to the gate G1. The first electrode CE1 may be integrally formed with the first gate G1.

(148) A third insulating layer **315** of the insulating layers IL is disposed on the second insulating layer **314**. The third insulating layer **315** covers the upper electrode UE. The third insulating layer **315** includes an inorganic material such as silicon oxide, silicon oxynitride, or silicon nitride, and may have a single-layered or a multi-layered structure that includes the above stated materials. In an embodiment, the third insulating layer **314** includes a plurality of silicon oxide layers and silicon nitride layers that are alternately stacked with each other.

(149) In addition, sources S2, S5, S6, and S7 (see FIG. 5), drains D2, D5, D6, and D7 (see FIG. 5), and gates G2, G5, G6, and G7 (see FIG. 5) of second, fifth, sixth, and seventh transistors T2, T5, T6, and T7 (see FIG. 5) are manufactured respectively through the same processes as the source S1, the drain D1, and the gate G1 of the first transistor T1.

(150) A semiconductor pattern is disposed on the third insulating layer **315**. Hereinafter, the semiconductor pattern directly disposed on the third insulating layer **315** will be referred to as a second semiconductor pattern. The second semiconductor pattern includes an oxide semiconductor. The oxide semiconductor includes a crystalline or an amorphous oxide semiconductor.

(151) For example, the oxide semiconductor is at least one of indium (In), gallium (Ga), stannum (Sn), zirconium (Zr), vanadium (V), hafnium (Hf), cadmium (Cd), germanium (Ge), chromium (Cr), titanium (Ti), or zinc (Zn). In addition, the oxide semiconductor includes at least one of indium-tin oxide (ITO), indium-gallium-zinc oxide (IGZO), zinc oxide (ZnO), indium-zinc oxide (IZnO), zinc-indium oxide (ZIO), indium oxide (InO), titanium oxide (TiO), indium-zinc-tin oxide (IZTO), zinc-tin oxide (ZTO), etc.

(152) A third transistor T3 includes a source S3, an active region A3, and a drain D3. The source S3, the active region A3, and the drain D3 of the third transistor T3 are formed from the second semiconductor pattern. The source S3 and the drain D3 of the third transistor T3 include a metal reduced from a metal oxide semiconductor. The source S3 and the drain D3 of the third transistor T3 each include a metal layer that includes the reduced metal.

(153) A fourth insulating layer **316** of the insulating layers IL is disposed on the third insulating layer **315**. The fourth insulating layer **316** covers the second semiconductor pattern. In an embodiment, the fourth insulating layer **316** includes an inorganic material such as silicon oxide, silicon oxynitride, or silicon nitride, and may have a single-layered or a multi-layered structure including the above stated materials.

(154) In an embodiment, the fourth insulating layer **316** is patterned to correspond to a gate G3 of the third transistor T3 to be disposed thereon. That is, the gate G3 and the fourth insulating layer **316** have the same shape on a plane.

(155) The gate G3 of the third transistor T3 is disposed on the fourth insulating layer **316**. The gate G3 is a part of a metal pattern. The gate G3 of the third transistor T3 at least partially overlaps the second semiconductor pattern disposed thereunder. For example, the gate G3 overlaps the active region A3 disposed thereunder. The gate G3 may have a single-layered or a multi-layered structure that includes a low-resistive conductive material such as molybdenum (Mo), aluminum (Al), copper (Cu), and/or titanium (Ti).

(156) A fifth insulating layer **317** of the insulating layers IL is disposed on the fourth insulating

layer **316**. The fifth insulating layer **317** covers the gate **G3**. In an embodiment, the fifth insulating layer **317** includes an inorganic material such as silicon oxide, silicon oxynitride, or silicon nitride, and may have a single-layered or a multi-layered structure that includes the above stated materials. In an embodiment, the fifth insulating layer **317** includes a plurality of silicon oxide layers and silicon nitride layers that are alternately stacked with each other.

(157) In addition, a source **S4** (see FIG. 5), a drain **D4** (see FIG. 5), and a gate **G4** (see FIG. 5) of the fourth transistor **T4** (see FIG. 5) are manufactured respectively through the same processes as the source **S3**, the drain **D3**, and the gate **G3** of the third transistor **T3**.

(158) The first insulating layer **313** to the fifth insulating layer **317** are referred to as the insulating layers **IL**. However, in an embodiment, at least one of the first insulating layer **313** to the fifth insulating layer **317** is omitted.

(159) At least one organic insulating layer is disposed on the fifth insulating layer **317**. In an embodiment, a first organic insulating layer **318**, a second organic insulating layer **319**, and a third organic insulating layer **320** are disposed on the fifth insulating layer **317**. Each of the first organic insulating layer **318**, the second organic insulating layer **319**, and the third organic insulating layer **320** is a single-layered polyimide-based resin layer. However, embodiments are not necessarily limited thereto. In an embodiment, each of the first organic insulating layer **318**, the second organic insulating layer **319**, and the third organic insulating layer **320** includes at least one of an acryl-based resin, a methacrylic-based resin, polyisoprene, a vinyl-based resin, an epoxy-based resin, an urethane-based resin, a cellulose-based resin, a siloxane-based resin, a polyamide-based resin, or a perylene-based resin.

(160) A first connecting electrode **CNE1** is disposed on the fifth insulating layer **317**. The first connecting electrode **CNE1** is connected to the connecting signal line **SCL** through a contact hole **CNT** that penetrates the first insulating layer **313** to the fifth insulating layer **317**.

(161) A second connecting electrode **CNE2** is disposed on the first organic insulating layer **318**. The second connecting electrode **CNE2** is connected to the first connecting electrode **CNE1** through a first via hole **VIA1** that penetrates the first organic insulating layer **318**.

(162) The light-emitting device **OLED1** is disposed on the third organic insulating layer **320**. The light-emitting device **OLED1** includes a pixel electrode **331**, an intermediate layer **332**, and an opposite electrode **333**. The pixel electrode **331** is disposed on the third organic insulating layer **320**. In addition, a pixel defining layer **323** is disposed on the third organic insulating layer **320**.

(163) The pixel electrode **331** is electrically connected to the second connecting electrode **CNE2** through a second via hole **VIA2** in the penetrates the second organic insulating layer **319** and the third organic insulating layer **320**. The pixel electrode **331** includes a conductive oxide such as indium tin oxide (ITO), indium zinc oxide (IZO), zinc oxide (ZnO), indium oxide (In.sub.2O.sub.3), indium gallium oxide, or aluminum zinc oxide (AZO). In an embodiment, the pixel electrode **331** includes a reflective layer that includes at least one of silver (Ag), magnesium (Mg), aluminum (Al), platinum (Pt), palladium (Pd), gold (Au), nickel (Ni), neodymium (Nd), iridium (Ir), chromium (Cr), or a compound thereof. In an embodiment, the pixel electrode **331** further includes a layer that includes at least one of ITO, IZO, ZnO, or In.sub.2O.sub.3 on and/or under the reflective layer. For example, the pixel electrode **331** has a multi-layered structure that includes ITO/Ag/ITO.

(164) The pixel defining layer **323** includes an opening **3230P** that exposes at least a part of the pixel electrode **331**, and is disposed on the pixel electrode **331** and the third organic insulating layer **320**. The opening **3230P** of the pixel defining layer **323** defines an emission area **EA** for light emitted from the light-emitting device **OLED1**. For example, a width of the opening **3230P** corresponds to a width of the emission area **EA**. A periphery of the emission area **EA** is a non-emission area **NEA**, and the non-emission area **NEA** surrounds the emission area **EA**.

(165) The pixel defining layer **323** includes an organic insulating material. In an embodiment, the pixel defining layer **323** includes an inorganic insulating material such as silicon nitride, silicon

oxynitride, or silicon oxide. In an embodiment, the pixel defining layer **323** includes an organic insulating material and an inorganic insulating material. In an embodiment, the pixel defining layer **323** is light-blocking material and is black. The light-blocking material includes at least one of carbon black, carbon nanotubes, a resin or a paste that includes a black dye, metal particles, such as nickel, aluminum, molybdenum, or an alloy thereof, metal oxide particles, such as chromium oxide, or metal nitride particles, such as chromium nitride, etc. When the pixel defining layer **323** includes a light-blocking material, external light reflection due to metal structures under the pixel defining layer **323** is reduced.

(166) In addition, a spacer is disposed on the pixel defining layer **323**. The spacer includes an organic insulating material such as polyimide. In an embodiment, the spacer includes an inorganic insulating material such as silicon nitride (SiN.sub.x) or silicon oxide (SiO.sub.2), or includes an organic insulating material and an inorganic insulating material.

(167) In an embodiment, the spacer includes the same material as the pixel defining layer **323**. The pixel defining layer **323** and the spacer are formed along with each other during a mask process that uses a halftone mask. In an embodiment, the spacer includes a different material from the pixel defining layer **323**.

(168) The intermediate layer **332** is disposed on the pixel electrode **331**. The intermediate layer **332** includes a first functional layer **332a**, an emission layer **332b**, and a second functional layer **332c** that are sequentially stacked. The first functional layer **332a** and the second functional layer **332c** are collectively referred to as an organic functional layer **332e**.

(169) The emission layer **332b** is formed in the opening **3230P** of the pixel defining layer **323**. The emission layer **332b** includes a polymer or a low-molecular weight organic material that emits predetermined color light.

(170) The organic functional layer **332e** includes at least one of the first functional layer **332a** between the pixel electrode **331** and the emission layer **332b**, and the second functional layer **332c** between the emission layer **332b** and the opposite electrode **333**. For example, the first functional layer **332a** is disposed between the pixel electrode **331** and the emission layer **332b**, and the second functional layer **332c** is omitted between the emission layer **332b** and the opposite electrode **333**. In an embodiment, the first functional layer **332a** between the pixel electrode **331** and the emission layer **332b** is omitted, and the second functional layer **332c** is disposed between the emission layer **332b** and the opposite electrode **333**. In an embodiment, the first functional layer **332a** is disposed between the pixel electrode **331** and the emission layer **332b**, and the second functional layer **332c** is disposed between the emission layer **332b** and the opposite electrode **333**. Hereinafter, an embodiment in which each of the first functional layer **332a** and the second functional layer **332c** is disposed will be described in detail.

(171) The first functional layer **332a** includes, for example, a hole transport layer (HTL), and a hole injection layer (HIL). The second functional layer **332c** includes an electron transport layer (ETL) and/or an electron injection layer (EIL). The first functional layer **332a** and/or the second functional layer **332c** are common layers that entirely cover the substrate **BS**.

(172) The opposite electrode **333** is formed on the organic functional layer **332e**. The opposite electrode **333** includes a conductive material that has a low work function. For example, the opposite electrode **333** includes a (semi-)transparent layer that includes at least one of silver (Ag), magnesium (Mg), aluminum (Al), platinum (Pt), palladium (Pd), gold (Au), nickel (Ni), neodymium (Nd), iridium (Ir), chromium (Cr), lithium (Li), calcium (Ca), or an alloy thereof. In an embodiment, the opposite electrode **333** further includes a layer that includes one of ITO, IZO, ZnO, or In.sub.2O.sub.3 disposed on the (semi-)transparent layer that includes the above material.

(173) In addition, a capping layer is further disposed on the opposite electrode **333**. The capping layer may include LiF, an inorganic material, and/or an organic material.

(174) An encapsulation member is disposed on the light-emitting device **OLED1**. The encapsulation member includes a thin film encapsulation layer **340**. In an embodiment, the thin

film encapsulation layer **340** is the encapsulation member, but embodiments are not necessarily limited thereto. In an embodiment, encapsulation member is an encapsulation substrate.

(175) The thin film encapsulation layer **340** includes at least one inorganic layer and at least one organic layer. For example, the thin film encapsulation layer **340** includes a first inorganic layer **341**, an organic layer **342**, and a second inorganic layer **343** that are sequentially stacked.

(176) The first inorganic layer **341** is disposed directly on the opposite electrode **333**. The first inorganic layer **341** prevents or reduces infiltration of external moisture or oxygen into the light-emitting device **OLED1**.

(177) The organic layer **342** is disposed directly on the first inorganic layer **341**. The organic layer **342** provides a flat surface on the first inorganic layer **341**. Curvatures, particles, etc., on an upper surface of the first inorganic layer **341** are covered by the organic layer **342**, and thus, an influence of the upper surface state of the first inorganic layer **341** on the elements formed on the organic layer **342** is prevented.

(178) The second inorganic layer **343** is disposed directly on the organic layer **342**. The second inorganic layer **343** prevents or reduces discharge of moisture, etc., from the organic layer **342**.

(179) The first and second inorganic layers **341** and **342** include one or more inorganic materials such as aluminum oxide, titanium oxide, tantalum oxide, hafnium oxide, zinc oxide, silicon oxide, silicon nitride, or silicon oxynitride. Each of the first inorganic layer **341** and the second inorganic layer **343** has a single-layered structure or a multi-layered structure that includes the above-mentioned materials. The organic layer **342** includes a polymer-based material. The polymer-based material is at least one of an acryl-based resin, an epoxy-based resin, polyimide, polyethylene, etc. In an embodiment, the organic layer **342** includes acrylate.

(180) An input sensor **350** is disposed on the encapsulation member. The input sensor **350** includes a plurality of conductive patterns **352** and **354**, a first sensing insulation layer **351**, a second sensing insulation layer **353**, and a third sensing insulation layer **355**.

(181) The first sensing insulation layer **351** is disposed on the encapsulation member. In addition, the first conductive patterns **352** is disposed on the first sensing insulation layer **351** and is covered by the second sensing insulation layer **353**. In addition, the second conductive patterns **354** is disposed on the second sensing insulation layer **353** and is covered by the third sensing insulation layer **355**. The first sensing insulation layer **351**, the second sensing insulation layer **353**, and the third sensing insulation layer **355** each include at least one of an inorganic material or an organic material.

(182) Each of the conductive patterns **352** and **354** are electrically conductive. Each of the conductive patterns **352** and **354** has a single layer or a multiple layer structure. In addition, at least one of the conductive patterns **352** and **354** includes mesh lines on a plane.

(183) The mesh lines in the conductive patterns **352** and **354** do not overlap the emission layer **332b** on a plane. Therefore, even when the input sensor **350** is directly formed on the display panel **50**, light generated by the pixels **PX** of the display panel **DP** propagates to a user without interference from the input sensor **350**.

(184) When a black matrix **360** is formed directly on the second conductive pattern **354**, the second conductive pattern **354** can be damaged during a process of patterning the black matrix **360**. Therefore, when the third sensing insulation layer **355** is disposed between the second conductive pattern **354** and the black matrix **360**, damage to the second conductive pattern **354** can be prevented or reduced.

(185) A color filter **370** is disposed on the input sensor **350**. The color filter **370** at least partially overlaps the emission layer **332b** disposed thereunder. The color filter **370** selectively transmits light that corresponds to light provided from the emission layer **332b**. For example, when the emission layer **332b** emits blue light, the color filter **370** includes a blue color filter that transmits blue light. When the emission layer **332b** emits green light, the color filter **370** includes a green color filter that transmits green light. When the emission layer **332b** emits red light, the color filter

370 includes a red color filter that transmits red light.

(186) The color filter **370** includes a polymer photosensitive resin and a pigment or a dye. For example, the color filter **370** that overlaps the emission layer **332b** that emits blue light includes a blue pigment or dye, the color filter **370** that overlaps the emission layer **332b** that emits green light includes a green pigment or dye, and the color filter **370** that overlaps the emission layer **332b** that emits red light includes a red pigment or dye.

(187) However, embodiments are not necessarily limited thereto, and in an embodiment, the color filter **370** that overlaps the emission layer **332b** that provides blue light does not include a pigment or a dye. The color filter **370** is transparent and includes a transparent photosensitive resin.

(188) The black matrix **360** is disposed between color filters **370** that provide different light from each other. The black matrix **360** has a pattern of black color, such as a lattice shaped matrix. The black matrix **360** includes a black coloring agent. The black coloring agent includes a black pigment and a black dye. The black coloring agent may include a metal such as carbon black and chrome, or an oxide thereof. In an embodiment, the black matrix **360** includes the same material as the pixel defining layer **323**.

(189) In an embodiment, the black matrix **360** includes an opening **3600P** that overlaps the emission area EA of the light-emitting device **OLED1**. A width of the opening **3600P** of the black matrix **360** is equal to or greater than a width of the emission area EA of the light-emitting device **OLED1** and/or the opening **3230P** of the pixel defining layer **323**. However, embodiments are not necessarily limited thereto. In an embodiment, the color filter **370** is located in the opening **3600P** of the black matrix **360**.

(190) An overcoat layer **380** is disposed on the color filter **370** and the black matrix **360**. The overcoat layer **380** includes a transmissive layer that surrounds irregularities generated while forming the black matrix **360** and provides a flat upper surface. For example, the overcoat layer **380** includes a light-transmissive organic material such as an acryl-based resin.

(191) Referring to FIG. 4B, the display panel **50** includes the substrate **BS**, the buffer layer **311**, the insulating layers **IL**, the light-emitting device **OLED1**, the thin film encapsulation layer **340**, and the input sensor **350**. Here, the display panel **50** does not include the color filter **370**, the black matrix **360**, and the overcoat layer **380**.

(192) FIG. 5 is an equivalent circuit diagram of a pixel of a display panel of FIG. 3.

(193) Referring to FIG. 5, in an embodiment, a pixel circuit **PC** includes the first transistor **T1**, the second transistor **T2**, the third transistor **T3**, the fourth transistor **T4**, the fifth transistor **T5**, the sixth transistor **T6**, the seventh transistor **T7**, the first storage capacitor **Cst**, and a second storage capacitor **Cbt**. In an embodiment, at least one of the first to seventh transistors **T1** to **T7** may be omitted.

(194) The first to seventh transistors **T1**, **T2**, **T3**, **T4**, **T5**, **T6**, and **T7** and the first and second storage capacitors **Cst** and **Cbt** are connected to signal lines, a first initialization voltage line **VL1**, a second initialization voltage line **VL2**, and a driving voltage line **PL**. The signal lines include a data line **DL**, a first scan line **SL1**, a second scan line **SL2**, a previous scan line **SLp**, a next scan line **SLn**, and an emission control line **EL**. In an embodiment, the signal lines, the first and second initialization voltage lines **VL1** and **VL2**, and/or the driving voltage line **PL** are shared by adjacent pixels.

(195) The driving voltage line **PL** transmits a first power voltage **ELVDD** to the first transistor **T1**. The first initialization voltage line **VIL1** transmits a first initialization voltage **Vint1** to the pixel circuit **PC** that initializes the first transistor **T1**. The second initialization voltage line **VIL2** transmits a second initialization voltage **Vint2** to the pixel circuit **PC** that initializes a light-emitting device **OLED**.

(196) The third transistor **T3** and the fourth transistor **T4** are implemented as n-channel MOSFET (NMOS) transistors, and the other transistors are implemented as p-channel MOSFET (PMOS) transistors. However, embodiments are not necessarily limited thereto. In an embodiment, the third

transistor T3, the fourth transistor T4, and the seventh transistor T7 are implemented as NMOS transistors, and the others are implemented as PMOS transistors.

(197) In the specification, a phase “a transistor and a signal line or a transistor and another transistor are electrically connected” indicates that “a source, a drain, and a gate of the transistor are integrally formed with a signal line or connected via a connecting electrode.”

(198) The first transistor T1 controls a magnitude of the driving current flowing from the driving voltage line PL to a light-emitting device OLED according to a gate voltage. The first transistor T1 includes the gate G1 connected to the first electrode CE1 of the first storage capacitor Cst, and the source S1 connected to the driving voltage line PL via the fifth transistor T5. In addition, the first transistor T1 includes the drain D1 connected to the light-emitting device OLED via the sixth transistor T6.

(199) The second transistor T2 receives a data voltage D in response to the first scan signal Sn. The second transistor T2 transmits the data voltage D to the source S1 of the first transistor T1, in response to the first scan signal Sn. The second transistor T2 includes the gate G2 connected to the first scan line SL1, the source S2 connected to the data line DL, and the drain D2 connected to the source S1 of the first transistor T1.

(200) The first storage capacitor Cst is connected between the driving voltage line PL and the first transistor T1. The first storage capacitor Cst includes the second electrode CE2 connected to the driving voltage line PL, and the first electrode CE1 connected to the gate G1 of the first transistor T1. The first storage capacitor Cst stores a difference between the first driving voltage ELVDD applied to the driving voltage line PL and a gate voltage of the first transistor T1, and maintains the gate voltage of the first transistor T1.

(201) The third transistor T3 is connected between the drain D1 and the gate G1 of the first transistor T1 in series and connects the drain D1 and the gate G1 of the first transistor T1 to each other in response to a second scan signal Sn'. The third transistor T3 includes the gate G3 connected to the second scan line SL2, the source S3 connected to the drain D1 of the first transistor T1, and the drain D3 connected to the gate G1 of the first transistor T1. In an embodiment, the third transistor T3 is implemented as a plurality of transistors that are connected to each other in series and simultaneously controlled by the second scan signal Sn'. In an embodiment, the third transistor T3 is omitted.

(202) When the third transistor T3 is turned on in response to the second scan signal Sn', the drain D1 and the gate G1 of the first transistor T1 are connected to diode-connect the first transistor T1.

(203) The fourth transistor T4 transmits the first initialization voltage Vint1 to the gate G1 of the first transistor T1, in response to the previous scan signal Sn-1. The fourth transistor T4 includes the gate G4 connected to the previous scan line SLp, the source S4 connected to the gate G1 of the first transistor T1, and the drain D4 connected to the first initialization voltage line VL1. In an embodiment, the fourth transistor T4 includes a plurality of transistors that are connected to each other in series and simultaneously controlled by the previous scan signal Sn-1. In an embodiment, the fourth transistor T4 is omitted.

(204) The fifth transistor T5 connects the driving voltage line PL to the source S1 of the first transistor T1 in response to a light-emitting control signal En. The fifth transistor T5 includes the gate G5 connected to the emission control line EL, the source S5 connected to the driving voltage line PL, and the drain D5 connected to the source S1 of the first transistor T1. In an embodiment, the fifth transistor T5 is omitted.

(205) The sixth transistor T6 connects the drain D1 of the first transistor T1 to an anode of the light-emitting device OLED in response to the light-emitting control signal En. The sixth transistor T6 transmits a driving current received from the first transistor T1 to the anode of the light-emitting device OLED. The sixth transistor T6 includes the gate G6 connected to the emission control line EL, the source S6 connected to the drain D1 of the first transistor T1, and the drain D6 connected to the anode of the light-emitting device OLED. In an embodiment, the sixth transistor

T6 is omitted.

(206) The seventh transistor T7 transmits the second initialization voltage Vint2 to the anode of the light-emitting device OLED in response to a next scan signal Sn+1. The seventh transistor T7 includes the gate G7 connected to the next scan line SLn, the source S7 connected to the anode of the light-emitting device OLED, and the drain D7 connected to the second initialization voltage line VL2. In an embodiment, the seventh transistor T7 is omitted.

(207) The seventh transistor T7 may be connected to the next scan line SLn as shown in FIG. 5. In an embodiment, the seventh transistor T7 is connected to the emission control line EL and is driven according to the light-emitting control signal En. In an embodiment, the seventh transistor T7 is connected to the previous scan line SLp and is driven according to the previous scan line SLp.

(208) In addition, according to embodiments, positions of the sources and the drains may be exchanged according to the types of the transistors (p-type or n-type).

(209) The second storage capacitor Cbt includes a third electrode CE3 and a fourth electrode CE4. The fourth electrode CE4 of the second storage capacitor Cbt is connected to the first electrode CE1 of the first storage capacitor Cst, and the third electrode CE3 of the second storage capacitor Cbt is provided with the first scan signal Sn. The second storage capacitor Cbt elevates a voltage of a gate terminal of the first transistor T1 at a time point when supply of the first scan signal Sn is stopped, and thus, compensates for a voltage drop of the gate terminal. In an embodiment, the second storage capacitor Cbt is omitted.

(210) Hereinafter, a reinforcing member is described in detail below. However, for convenience of description, the reinforcing member provided in a display device shown in FIG. 2A will be described in detail.

(211) FIG. 6A is a perspective view of a reinforcing member 60 of a display device of FIG. 1A or FIG. 2A. FIG. 6B is a cross-sectional view of the reinforcing member 60 of FIG. 6A taken along line D-D'.

(212) Referring to FIGS. 6A and 6B, in an embodiment, the reinforcing member 60 includes a first reinforcing member layer 60-2 and a second reinforcing member layer 60-1. The first reinforcing member layer 60-2 is inserted into the second reinforcing member layer 60-1.

(213) A thickness of the reinforcing member 60 is from about 50 μm to about 200 μm . When the thickness of the reinforcing member 60 is less than 50 μm , the display panel 50 might not be supported, and thus, the display panel 50 might not be maintained flat when unfolding the display panel 50. In addition, when the thickness of the reinforcing member 60 exceeds 200 μm , the folding of the display device 1 might not be smoothly performed. The thickness is a distance from a lower surface to an upper surface of the reinforcing member 60.

(214) The second reinforcing member layer 60-1 includes at least one of a silicon-based polymer, a urethane-based polymer, an aramid-based polymer, or elastomer. In addition, the first reinforcing member layer 60-2 includes at least one of aluminum, stainless steel (SUS), glass fiber, or carbon fiber.

(215) In an embodiment, the second reinforcing member layer 60-1 covers and surrounds the first reinforcing member layer 60-2. The first reinforcing member layer 60-2 may be entirely disposed in the second reinforcing member layer 60-1 or may be only partially disposed in the second reinforcing member layer 60-1. A reinforcing member folding area 60a is an area of the reinforcing member 60 that is located on the folding portion of the display device 1, and is an area where the first reinforcing member layer 60-2 and the second reinforcing member layer 60-1 are both formed.

(216) In an embodiment, when the reinforcing member folding area 60a does not include the entire reinforcing member 60, the region 60b other than the reinforcing member folding area 60a only includes the second reinforcing member layer 60-1.

(217) In an embodiment, the first reinforcing member layer 60-2 has a lattice shape. For example, the first reinforcing member layer 60-2 includes open areas HO. The open areas HO may each have a square shape or a rectangular shape. A side of an open area HO is parallel to one of a lengthwise

direction or a width direction of the reinforcing member **60**. The open area HO includes a plurality of open areas HO, and the plurality of open areas HO are spaced apart from each other at constant intervals.

(218) A thickness of the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** is from about 10 μm to about 100 μm . When the thickness of the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** is less than 10 μm , the display device **1** might not remain flat when unfolding the display device **1**. In addition, when the thickness of the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** exceeds 100 μm , the display device **1** might not be smoothly folded when folding the display device **1**, or a curvature radius of the folded area of the display device **1** may be too large.

(219) In an embodiment, an elastic coefficient of the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** is from about 10 GPa to about 70 GPa. In addition, an elastic coefficient of the second reinforcing member layer **60-1** is from about 0.1 GPa to about 10 GPa.

(220) In an embodiment, when the elastic coefficient of the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** is less than 10 GPa, an excessive force may be needed to fold the display device **1** because the deformation does not occur easily. In addition, when the elastic coefficient of the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** exceeds 70 GPa, the deformation can occur with only a small force, and the display panel **50** might not be supported by the folding area of the display device **1** when unfolding the display device **1**.

(221) In addition, when the elastic coefficient of the second reinforcing member layer **60-1** is less than 0.1 GPa, the deformation does not occur easily, and an excessive force may be needed to fold the display device **1**. In addition, when the elastic coefficient of the second reinforcing member layer **60-1** exceeds 10 GPa, the deformation can occur with a small force, and thus, the display panel **50** might not be supported by the folding area of the display device **1** when unfolding the display device **1**.

(222) In an embodiment, because the reinforcing member folding area **60a** corresponds to the folding area of the display device as described above, the display device **1** is sufficiently rigid so that the display device **1** continues to unfold when unfolding the display device **1**. In addition, because one surface of the reinforcing member **60** is maintained flat and uniform, the surface of the display panel **50** that displays an image is not curved, when unfolding the display panel **50**.

(223) FIGS. 7A to 7E are cross-sectional views of the reinforcing member **60** of the display device according to embodiments of the disclosure.

(224) Referring to FIG. 7A, in an embodiment, the reinforcing member **60** includes a first reinforcing member layer **60-2** and a second reinforcing member layer **60-1**. The second reinforcing member layer **60-1** is disposed on the first reinforcing member layer **60-2**. The first reinforcing member layer **60-2** is formed not only in the reinforcing member folding area **60a**, but also in the other area **60b** of the reinforcing member **60**. The first reinforcing member layer **60-2** in the reinforcing member folding area **60a** includes the open areas HO as shown in FIG. 6A. The first reinforcing member layer **60-2** that is not arranged in the reinforcing member folding area **60a** has a flat plate shape. That is, the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** may include a 1-1st reinforcing member layer **60-2a** that defines the open area HO and a 1-2nd reinforcing member layer **60-2b** that has a plate shape.

(225) The second reinforcing member layer **60-1** is partially inserted in the open areas HO of the first reinforcing member layer **60-2**, and covers the first reinforcing member layer **60-2**. The second reinforcing member layer **60-1** includes a 2-1st reinforcing member layer **60-1a** and a 2-2nd reinforcing member layer **60-1b**. The 2-1st reinforcing member layer **60-1a** shields the open areas HO and is partially inserted in the open areas HO, and the 2-2nd reinforcing member layer **60-1b** has a plate shape and is disposed on the 1-2nd reinforcing member layer **60-2b**.

(226) The second reinforcing member layer **60-1** includes at least one of a silicon-based polymer, a urethane-based polymer, an aramid-based polymer, or elastomer. In addition, the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** includes at least one of aluminum, stainless steel (SUS), glass fiber, or carbon

fiber.

(227) Referring to FIG. 7B, in an embodiment, the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** is disposed on the entire surface of the display panel **50**. The first reinforcing member layer **60-2** includes the open areas HO formed therein, and the second reinforcing member layer **60-1** shields the open areas HO. The first reinforcing member layer **60-2** includes the 1-1st reinforcing member layer **60-2a** that defines the open area HO, and the 1-2nd reinforcing member layer **60-2b** that has a plate shape and is connected to the 1-1st reinforcing member layer **60-2a**. The 1-1st reinforcing member layer **60-2a** is formed in the folding area of the display panel **50**, and the 1-2nd reinforcing member layer **60-2b** is arranged in the non-folding area of the display panel **50**.

(228) The second reinforcing member layer **60-1** includes at least one of a silicon-based polymer, a urethane-based polymer, an aramid-based polymer, or elastomer. In addition, the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** includes at least one of aluminum, stainless steel (SUS), glass fiber, or carbon fiber.

(229) Referring to FIG. 7C, in an embodiment, the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** is disposed adjacent to the display panel **50**, and the second reinforcing member layer **60-1** is disposed on a lower surface of the first reinforcing member layer **60-2**. The first reinforcing member layer **60-2** includes the 1-1st reinforcing member layer **60-2a** that defines the open areas HO, and the 1-2nd reinforcing member layer **60-2b** that is connected to the 1-1st reinforcing member layer **60-2a**. In addition, the second reinforcing member layer **60-1** includes the 2-1st reinforcing member layer **60-1a** that is inserted into the open areas HO, and the 2-2nd reinforcing member layer **60-1b** that is disposed under and corresponds to the 1-2nd reinforcing member layer **60-2b**.

(230) The second reinforcing member layer **60-1** includes at least one of a silicon-based polymer, a urethane-based polymer, an aramid-based polymer, or elastomer. In addition, the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** includes at least one of aluminum, stainless steel (SUS), glass fiber, or carbon fiber.

(231) Referring to FIG. 7D, in an embodiment, the second reinforcing member layer **60-1** is inserted into the first reinforcing member layer **60-2**. The second reinforcing member layer **60-1** has a lattice shape. In addition, the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** is inserted in the open areas of the lattice shape of the second reinforcing member layer **60-1**. Lattice-shaped holes are formed in the first reinforcing member layer **60-2**, and then, the second reinforcing member layer **60-1** may be injected thereinto.

(232) The second reinforcing member layer **60-1** includes at least one of a silicon-based polymer, a urethane-based polymer, an aramid-based polymer, or elastomer. In addition, the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** includes at least one of aluminum, stainless steel (SUS), glass fiber, or carbon fiber.

(233) Referring to FIG. 7E, in an embodiment, the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** has a lattice shape in the entire the reinforcing member **60**. The second reinforcing member layer **60-1** entirely surrounds the first reinforcing member layer **60-2**. For example, the second reinforcing member layer **60-1** is inserted into the first reinforcing member layer **60-2**.

(234) The second reinforcing member layer **60-1** includes at least one of a silicon-based polymer, a urethane-based polymer, an aramid-based polymer, or elastomer. In addition, the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** includes at least one of aluminum, stainless steel (SUS), glass fiber, or carbon fiber.

(235) In an above-described structure, according to embodiments, the second reinforcing member layer **60-1** may be arranged in the position of the first reinforcing member layer **60-2**, and the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** may be arranged in the position of the second reinforcing member layer **60-1**. In addition, the lattice of the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** or the second reinforcing member layer **60-1** may be arranged in at least two spaced apart portions of the reinforcing member **60**, not in one part of the reinforcing member **60** as shown in FIG. 6A, 6B, 7A, 7B, 7C, or 7D. In an embodiment, the lattice of the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** or the

second reinforcing member layer **60-1** is arranged in the entire reinforcing member **60** as shown in FIG. 7E.

(236) Therefore, through the combination of the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** and the second reinforcing member layer **60-1**, a force is secured that supports the display panel **50**, and the folding of the display panel **50** is enabled.

(237) FIG. **8** is a plan view of one of the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** or the second reinforcing member layer **60-1** in the reinforcing member **60** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(238) Referring to FIG. **8**, in an embodiment, the lattice of the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** or the second reinforcing member layer **60-1** may have various shapes. For example, the open areas HO in the lattice each have a rhombus shape. One side of the open area HO extends in an inclined direction with respect to a side of the display device **1**.

(239) In an embodiment, when the display device **1** is folded, an elongation of the second reinforcing member layer **60-1** or the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** in the folded part of the display device is increased.

(240) FIG. **9** is a plan view of one of the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** and the second reinforcing member layer **60-1** in the reinforcing member **60** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(241) Referring to FIG. **9**, in an embodiment, the reinforcing member **60** further includes an auxiliary layer **60-3** disposed in the open area HO formed by one of the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** or the second reinforcing member layer **60-1**. The auxiliary layer **60-3** is connected to one of the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** or the second reinforcing member layer **60-1**. In addition, the other of the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** or the second reinforcing member layer **60-1** is inserted into the open areas HO. The auxiliary layer **60-3** is inserted into the other of the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** or the second reinforcing member layer **60-1**.

(242) For example, when the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** has a lattice shape and forms the open areas HO, the auxiliary layer **60-3** is connected to the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** and extends through the open areas HO. The auxiliary layer **60-3** includes the same material as the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** and is integrally formed with the first reinforcing member layer **60-2**.

(243) For example, when the second reinforcing member layer **60-1** has a lattice shape, the auxiliary layer **60-3** is connected to the second reinforcing member layer **60-1**. The auxiliary layer **60-3** includes the same material as the second reinforcing member layer **60-1** and is integrally formed with the second reinforcing member layer **60-1**.

(244) The auxiliary layer **60-3** as above increases the strength of which of the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** or the second reinforcing member layer **60-1** has a lattice shape.

(245) In an embodiment, a cross-sectional area of the auxiliary layer **60-3** perpendicular to the lengthwise direction of the auxiliary layer **60-3** is less than a cross-sectional area of one of the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** or the second reinforcing member layer **60-1** perpendicular to the lengthwise direction, such as an x-axis direction or a y-axis direction of FIG. **9**, of one of the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** or the second reinforcing member layer **60-1**.

(246) FIG. **10** is a plan view of one of the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** or the second reinforcing member layer **60-1** in the reinforcing member **60** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(247) Referring to FIG. **10**, in an embodiment, one of the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** or the second reinforcing member layer **60-1** includes open areas HO. A planar shape of the open area HO is circular. The other of the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** or the second reinforcing member layer **60-1** is inserted into the open areas HO.

(248) FIG. **11** is a plan view of one of the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** or the second reinforcing member layer **60-1** in the reinforcing member **60** according to an embodiment of the

present disclosure.

(249) Referring to FIG. 11, in an embodiment, one of the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** or the second reinforcing member layer **60-1** includes open areas HO. A planar shape of each of the open areas HO is hexagonal. The other of the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** or the second reinforcing member layer **60-1** is inserted into the open areas HO. In addition, the planar shape of the open area HO may be any polygonal shape.

(250) FIGS. 12A and 12B are plan views of one of the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** or the second reinforcing member layer **60-1** in the reinforcing member **60** according to an embodiment of the disclosure.

(251) Referring to FIGS. 12A and 12B, in an embodiment, one of the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** or the second reinforcing member layer **60-1** includes open areas HO. A planar shape of each of the open areas HO is elliptical. The other of the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** or the second reinforcing member layer **60-1** is inserted into the open areas HO.

(252) In an embodiment, the open areas HO is elongated in one direction. For example, the open areas HO are elongated in the x-axis direction as shown in FIG. 12A. In an embodiment, the open area HO are elongated in the y-axis direction as shown in FIG. 12B.

(253) FIG. 13 is a plan view of one of a first reinforcing member layer or a second reinforcing member layer in a reinforcing member according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(254) Referring to FIG. 13, in an embodiment, one of the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** or the second reinforcing member layer **60-1** includes open areas HO. A planar shape of each of the open areas HO is circular or polygonal. The other of the first reinforcing member layer **60-2** or the second reinforcing member layer **60-1** is inserted into the open areas HO.

(255) In an embodiment, the open areas HO in different columns (or rows) have different shapes from each other. For example, the planar shape of the open area HO in a central column CL1 (or row) has a circular shape, and the planar shapes of the open areas HO in a first left column CL2 (or first upper row) or a first right column CL3 (or first lower row) each have a polygonal shape, such as a square shape.

(256) The planar shape of the open area HO may be variously modified. For example, the planar shapes of the open areas HO might not be symmetrical with each other with respect to the central column CL1 (or central row) as shown in FIG. 13, but the open areas HO at the first right column CL3 (or first upper row) and the first left column CL2 (or first lower row) with respect to the central column CL1 (or central row) may have different planar shapes. In an embodiment, the open areas HO in the central column CL1 (or central row) may have polygonal planar shapes, circular planar shapes in the first left column CL2 (or first upper row), and non-defined planar shapes in the first right column CL3 (or first lower row). In an embodiment, the planar shapes of the open areas HO may vary in every column (or row).

(257) In an embodiment, when the open areas HO are arranged in a plurality of columns (or rows) that are on the left (or upper) or right (or lower) side of the central column CL1 (or row), the planar shapes of the open areas HO in respective columns (or rows) may differ from one another.

(258) In an embodiment, one of the open areas HO may have a planar shape that differs from the planar shapes of the others in the same column (or row).

(259) A display device according to embodiments of the disclosure provides clear images. A display device according to embodiments of the disclosure maintains a display surface that displays images as flat as possible while being unfolded.

(260) It should be understood that embodiments described herein should be considered in a descriptive sense only and not for purposes of limitation. Descriptions of features or aspects within each embodiment should typically be considered as available for other similar features or aspects in other embodiments. While embodiments have been described with reference to the figures, it will be understood by those of ordinary skill in the art that various changes in form and details may be made therein without departing from the spirit and scope as defined by the following claims.

Claims

1. A display device, comprising: a foldable display panel; a reinforcing member disposed on one surface of the display panel and that supports an entire surface of the display panel; and a cushion layer disposed on one surface of the reinforcing member, wherein the reinforcing member comprises: a first reinforcing member layer; and a second reinforcing member layer that is inserted into the first reinforcing member layer or at least partially surrounds the first reinforcing member layer, wherein one of the first reinforcing member layer or the second reinforcing member layer has a plurality of open areas, when viewed in a plan view, wherein each of the plurality of open areas is surrounded by a solid portion of the one of the first reinforcing member layer or the second reinforcing member layer.
2. The display device of claim 1, wherein one of the first reinforcing member layer or the second reinforcing member layer includes at least one of metal, glass reinforced fiber, or carbon reinforced fiber.
3. The display device of claim 2, wherein an other of the first reinforcing member layer or the second reinforcing member layer includes at least one of a silicon-based polymer, a urethane-based polymer, an aramid-based polymer, or elastomer.
4. The display device of claim 1, wherein the plurality of open areas are spaced apart from each other at constant intervals.
5. The display device of claim 1, wherein each open area of the plurality of open areas has at least one of a non-defined shape, a polygonal shape, a circular shape, or an elliptical shape.
6. The display device of claim 1, wherein the reinforcing member further comprises an auxiliary layer disposed in the open area.
7. The display device of claim 6, wherein the auxiliary layer is integrally formed with and includes a same material as one of the first reinforcing member layer or the second reinforcing member layer.
8. The display device of claim 7, wherein a cross-sectional area of the auxiliary layer perpendicular to a lengthwise direction of the auxiliary layer is less than a cross-sectional area of at least one of the first reinforcing member layer or the second reinforcing member layer perpendicular to a lengthwise direction of at least one of the first reinforcing member layer or the second reinforcing member layer.
9. The display device of claim 1, further comprising a digitizer disposed on a lower surface of the reinforcing member or between the reinforcing member and the display panel.
10. The display device of claim 1, wherein a thickness of the reinforcing member is from about 50 μm to about 200 μm .
11. A display device, comprising: a cover member; a display panel disposed on a lower portion of the cover member; a reinforcing member disposed on a lower portion of the display panel; and a digitizer disposed on a lower portion of the reinforcing member, wherein the reinforcing member comprises: a first reinforcing member layer that has a lattice shape, when viewed in a plan view, wherein the lattice shape includes a plurality of open areas; and a second reinforcing member layer disposed on a surface of the first reinforcing member layer or that surrounds the first reinforcing member layer.
12. The display device of claim 11, wherein each of the plurality of the open areas have at least one of a circular shape, a polygonal shape, an elliptical shape, or a non-defined shape.
13. The display device of claim 12, wherein at least a part of the second reinforcing member layer has the lattice shape.
14. The display device of claim 12, wherein one of the first reinforcing member layer or the second reinforcing member layer includes at least one of metal, glass reinforced fiber, or carbon reinforced fiber, and an other of the first reinforcing member layer or the second reinforcing member layer

includes at least one of a silicon-based polymer, a urethane-based polymer, an aramid-based polymer, or elastomer.

15. The display device of claim 14, wherein an elastic coefficient of one of the first reinforcing member layer or the second reinforcing member layer is from about 10 GPa to about 70 GPa.

16. The display device of claim 14, wherein an elastic coefficient of the other of the first reinforcing member layer or the second reinforcing member layer is from about 0.1 GPa to about 10 GPa.

17. The display device of claim 12, wherein the reinforcing member further comprises an auxiliary layer connected to the first reinforcing member layer and disposed in the open areas, wherein the auxiliary layer includes the same material as the first reinforcing member layer and is integrally formed with the first reinforcing member layer.

18. The display device of claim 17, wherein a cross-sectional area of the auxiliary layer is less than a cross-sectional area of the first reinforcing member layer.

19. The display device of claim 11, wherein a thickness of the first reinforcing member layer is from about 10 μm to about 100 μm .

20. The display device of claim 11, wherein a thickness of the reinforcing member is from about 50 μm to about 200 μm .

21. A display device, comprising: a foldable display panel; and a reinforcing member disposed on one surface of the display panel and that supports an entire surface of the display panel, wherein the reinforcing member comprises: a first reinforcing member layer that has a lattice shape, when viewed in a plan view, wherein the lattice shape includes a plurality of open areas; and a second reinforcing member layer that is inserted into the first reinforcing member layer or at least partially surrounds the first reinforcing member layer.
